

OPENCLAW MASTERCLASS

OpenClaw The Complete Guide

Your plain-English introduction to the AI agent that actually does things for you.

"The lobster way" — your personal assistant, running on your own hardware, answering messages from anywhere.

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Created for OpenClaw Masterclass students



WHAT'S INSIDE

Your roadmap for this guide.

Everything you need to know before you start the course — in plain English.

01

What is OpenClaw?

The AI agent that actually does things

02

OpenClaw vs Claude vs ChatGPT

What makes OpenClaw different

03

How OpenClaw Works

Gateway, channels, skills explained simply

04

Where to Run It

Your laptop, a cheap cloud server, or your own hardware

05

What Skills Are

How your agent learns new tricks

06

Picking Your AI Model

Free, cheap, and premium options

07

What You Can Actually Build

Real use cases with real results

08

Getting Started Safely

The security basics every user needs

09

Where This Course Takes You

Your roadmap from beginner to power user

Your personal AI, always in your pocket.

An AI assistant that lives on your own computer and responds through the chat apps you already use every day.

THE IDEA

You message. It acts.

Send a message from WhatsApp, Telegram, Slack, or any chat app you already use, and your AI agent responds, plans, and actually does things for you.

- Message from anywhere
- Works in the apps you already have
- Always on, always ready

HOW IT RUNS

On your hardware.

OpenClaw runs on your own computer or a cheap cloud server you control. Your data stays with you. No subscription to a chat service, no one reading your messages.

- Fully self-hosted
- Open source and free
- You own the whole thing

WHAT IT DOES

Real work. Not just chat.

Unlike a regular chatbot, OpenClaw can take actions on your behalf. Send emails, manage calendars, organise files, do research, run on a schedule, and a whole lot more.

- Sends and reads your email
- Manages your calendar
- Works while you sleep

Think of it as your own private assistant — always on, always ready, and working exactly the way you want.

Most AI tools talk. OpenClaw acts.

There's a big difference between AI that tells you what to do and AI that does it for you.

THE USUAL WAY

Regular AI chatbots

They give advice. You do the work.

You ask it to write a report — it gives you text to copy and paste.
You ask it to sort your files — it tells you the steps to follow.
You ask it to email someone — it drafts a message for you to send.
You ask it to run a check every morning — it can't, you have to open it each time.

The real work still falls on you.

THE OPENCLAW WAY

An AI that takes action

You describe the outcome. It handles the rest.

You ask it to write a report — it builds the file and saves it to your drive.
You ask it to sort your files — it actually moves, renames and organises them.
You ask it to email someone — it sends the email from your account.
You ask it to run a check every morning — it wakes up and does it without you.

The work gets done. You stay focused.

This is the shift. OpenClaw isn't just smarter — it closes the loop between what you want and what actually gets done.

Same AI engine. Different tool.

OpenClaw uses the same AI models as Claude and ChatGPT — but the way you interact with it is fundamentally different.

REGULAR CHATBOTS

Claude & ChatGPT

Chat in your browser

- Open a browser tab
- Type questions, get answers
- Copy the answer back to your work
- Memory resets when you close the tab

Great for questions. Not for ongoing work.

FOR DEVELOPERS

Claude Code

AI that codes for you

- Lives in your terminal
- Reads, writes, and runs code
- Fixes bugs and deploys projects
- Requires developer skills

Powerful — but for coders only.

FOR EVERYONE

OpenClaw

An agent that takes action

- Lives in the chat apps you use
- Takes actions on your behalf
- Remembers you across sessions
- Works while you sleep

Plain English in. Real actions out.

Claude Code unlocked AI for developers. OpenClaw unlocks AI for everyone — from your phone, on your own terms.

Three building blocks.

One simple system.

The whole thing is made up of three main parts — and you don't need to understand any of them deeply to use it.

01

The Gateway

The engine

A small program that runs on your computer. It handles the AI, manages your sessions, and keeps track of everything. This is the one thing that has to be running for your agent to work.

- Runs on your machine
- Connects to the AI model
- Remembers conversations

02

The Channels

Where you talk to it

The chat apps where your agent lives. Telegram, WhatsApp, Slack, iMessage, Discord, Signal, and more. You connect them once and your agent becomes available everywhere.

- Telegram, Slack, WhatsApp
- iMessage, Discord, Signal
- Plus a web dashboard

03

The Skills

What it knows how to do

Small packages of instructions that teach your agent specific skills — like managing your Gmail, writing in your voice, or updating a spreadsheet. You add them as you need them.

- Add new abilities anytime
- Browse a public library
- Or build your own

Gateway + Channels + Skills = your personal AI agent. You don't need to build any of it from scratch — the course walks you through each piece.

Talk to your agent from anywhere.

You don't have to learn a new app. Your agent meets you where you already are.

Telegram

The fastest to set up and the most popular choice. Works great for personal use.

WhatsApp

Chat with your agent the same way you chat with friends and family.

Slack

Perfect for teams. Pull your agent into any workspace channel.

iMessage

Native Apple messaging with no extra apps needed on your iPhone.

Discord

For communities. Can respond in multiple servers at once.

Plus more

Signal, Google Chat, Teams, Matrix, Zalo, and a web dashboard too.

One gateway, every app. You set up your agent once and connect as many channels as you want. In the course we start with Telegram because it's the quickest to get running.

Three ways to run it.

You pick what fits.

Your agent needs a place to live. Here are your three main options, from easiest to most powerful.

OPTION A

Your own computer

Free. Simple. Local.

Best for: trying things out, testing, or if you don't need your agent running 24/7.

- Zero hosting cost
- Takes 5 minutes to set up
- Stops when your computer sleeps
- Great for getting started

\$0/month

OPTION B — RECOMMENDED

A cheap cloud server

Always on. Accessible anywhere.

Best for: real use where you want your agent available 24/7, even from your phone.

- Runs day and night
- Responds even while you sleep
- Accessible from anywhere
- What the course uses

From \$5/month

OPTION C

Your own hardware

Mac Mini or home server.

Best for: advanced users who want full control and may want to run local AI models.

- One-time cost, no monthly fees
- Full control over everything
- Can run AI models locally
- Requires more setup

Hardware cost only

Our recommendation: if you want your agent to be genuinely useful, go with Option B. The course uses Hostinger because it's beginner-friendly, and the setup is covered step by step.

How your agent learns new tricks.

Your agent is smart by default — but skills are what turn it into an expert at the specific things you need.

BY DEFAULT

A smart generalist

Your agent is already powerful out of the box. It can chat, reason, help with tasks, and access your connected apps.

- Good at general tasks
- Works with any topic
- But doesn't know your way of doing things

A SKILL

Your way of doing things

A simple plain-text file that teaches your agent how to do a specific task the way you want it done. No code. Just instructions in English.

- Step-by-step instructions
- Your tone, your style
- Triggers automatically when needed

THE RESULT

An expert on demand

Your agent now handles that task exactly the way you need — every single time, without you having to re-explain yourself.

- Consistent quality
- Zero re-briefing
- Runs the same way every session

Think of it like onboarding a new hire. You write down how something should be done once. From then on, your agent does it that way — perfectly, every single time.

Three ways to get the skills you need.

You don't have to build everything from scratch. Most of the time, someone already has.

01

Built-in skills

Included from day one

Your agent comes with useful skills already included — for example, managing your Google Workspace, creating files, doing research on the web.

- Ready to use right after install
- Covers the common stuff

02

The skill library

Install with one command

There's a public library of skills other people have built and shared. Browse, install, and your agent has a new ability instantly.

- Browse at clawhub.ai
- New skills added weekly

03

Your own skills

Built to your exact needs

When you need something specific, you can build your own skill in plain English. Your agent helps you write it.

- No code needed
- Covered in the course

You start with what's built in, add what others have made, and only build your own when you need something truly custom.

The AI model is the brain.

You choose it.

OpenClaw is free and open source. What costs money is the AI model that powers it — and you've got plenty of options.

FREE

Start for zero

Great for trying things out

Several free models are available — a bit slower, with some limits, but a real way to try OpenClaw without spending a cent.

- MiniMax, Gemini Flash
- Rate limits apply
- Works end-to-end

\$0/month

CHEAP

Around \$20/month

Reliable and fast

Connect your existing ChatGPT subscription, or use a pay-per-use option like Claude Haiku. Great balance between cost and quality.

- ChatGPT Plus via OAuth
- Or Kimi, Haiku, GPT Mini
- Predictable monthly cost

Around \$20/mo

PREMIUM

The best quality

For serious daily use

Claude Sonnet or Opus through the Anthropic API. Top-tier reasoning and tool use. You pay per use.

- Claude Sonnet / Opus
- Pay per token
- Typical use: \$20–\$100/mo

\$20–\$100+/mo

Smart routing changes everything. You can mix and match — use a cheap model for routine tasks and a premium one only for the hard stuff. This can cut your costs by 60–70%.

What it actually does all day.

Here's a taste of what people are really building with OpenClaw. All of these are covered in the course.

Daily briefings

Wake up to a summary of your emails, calendar, tasks, and news — delivered to your phone before your coffee.

Research reports

Ask for a deep dive on any topic. Your agent researches, writes, and saves a full report to your drive.

Email triage

Your agent reads your inbox, sorts important from noise, and drafts replies for your approval.

Smart reminders

Context-aware nudges that know when a follow-up is overdue, a bill is due, or a task is slipping.

Content factory

Turn a single idea into blog posts, tweets, newsletter copy — all matched to your tone of voice.

Your second brain

Connect your notes, documents, and memory. Ask questions and get answers based on your own knowledge.

The course walks you through building each of these. By the end you'll have a working agent that does real things for you every day.

Why security matters even at home.

Your agent has real access to your email, files, and accounts. A few simple habits keep everything safe without making your life harder.

Use dedicated accounts

Don't connect your agent to your personal Gmail or Google account. Create separate accounts just for the agent. If anything goes wrong, the damage stays contained.

Set spending limits

Every paid AI provider lets you set a hard monthly spending cap. Set one. A misconfigured agent can burn through credits fast.

Know the golden rule

Tell your agent *what* you want, not *how* to do it. It already knows how. Over-specifying leads to strange choices.

Watch out for prompt injection

Emails or web pages your agent reads may contain hidden instructions. Teach your agent to treat external content as data, not commands.

The course covers every one of these in detail. You don't need to be a security expert — you just need to follow a short checklist.

Here's where this course takes you.

From your first install to a fully working agent you actually rely on — every step is covered.

START

Course Introduction

Understand what OpenClaw is, how it compares to other AI tools, and whether it's right for you.

SETUP

Installing OpenClaw

Get your agent up and running on your computer or a cheap VPS. Connect Telegram and send your first message.

MODELS

Picking Your AI

Set up a free, cheap, or premium model. Configure smart routing to save on costs.

SKILLS

Extending Your Agent

Install pre-built skills, connect Google Workspace, and build your first custom skill.

PROJECTS

Real Use Cases

Build actual projects — a landing page, a competitor watch, a daily briefing, an email automation.

ADVANCED

Mission Control

Build your own custom dashboard, make it accessible from your phone, and secure the whole thing.

By the end, you'll have a working AI agent that does real work for you every day. Not in theory. In your actual life.

READY TO START?

Let's build your AI agent together.

You now know what OpenClaw is, how it works, and what it can do. The rest is just following along — and the course is designed for exactly that.

Every lesson walks you through a real setup, step by step. You'll see me run into real problems and fix them on camera. Nothing is hidden, nothing is smoothed over. That way, when you hit the same problems, you'll know exactly what to do.

So keep this guide handy, open the first lesson, and let's get your agent running. I'll see you in the course.

— *Damian*



OpenClaw Masterclass — by Damian Danelczyk.